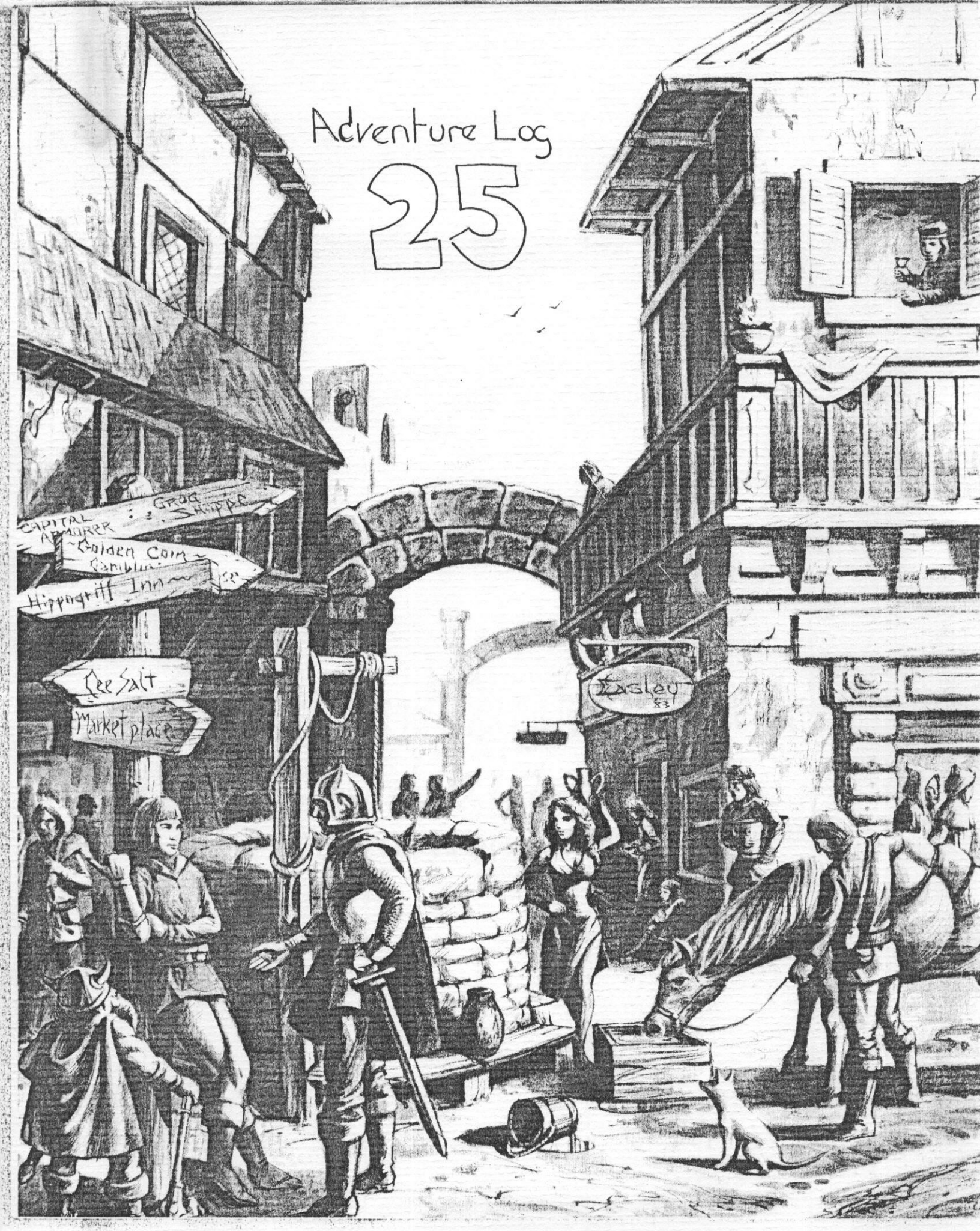

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GROG SHOPPE
Hippogriff Inn
See Salt
Market place
Easley

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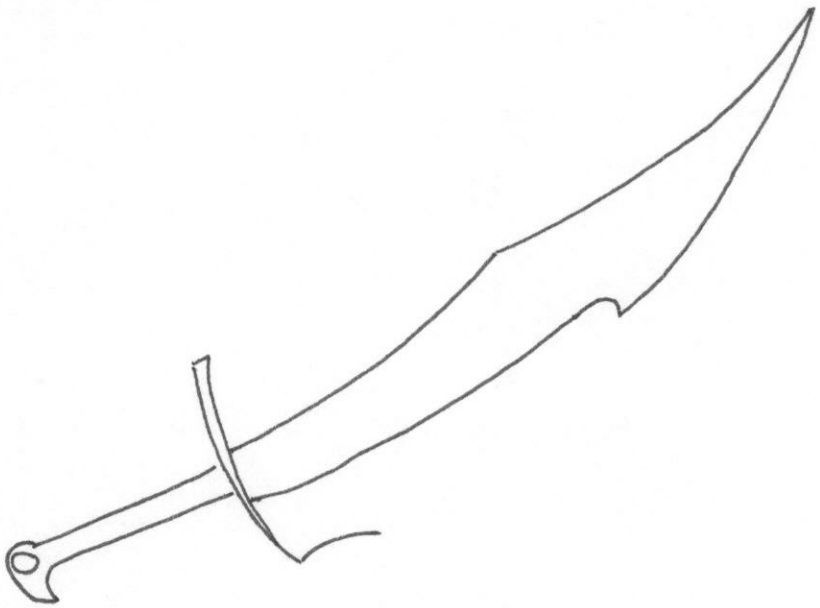
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`Dominion Spells' by Jon Pickens
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*`Bobo the Brown' [Yes, he's here! Better than Zippy and cuter too!] by Alex

REGULAR OFFERINGS

`Renegades Chapter VIII: The Dragondome' by Chris
`Renegades Chapter IX: Happenings' by Chris
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>>>>cover: Easley
`Lark-Han'
>>>>art: Todd & various artists
>>>>production: Chris
>>>>assistance: The Rat



The
-Renegades-
Chapter VIII: The Dragondome

Fogs rolled across the flowing waters of the Greyflood, scattering at the arrival of the pre-dawn breeze. The docks creaked and swayed silently, the stillness only challenged by an occasional boat knocking against its pier.

And so it was on the 52nd of Winter of the year 3111n, as the tall ship 'Tolfalas' slid quietly into the river. At its prow stood a tall knight bearing the coat-of-arms of Sir Warren of Gorgmir. By him was hunched the short figure of a scruffy Halfling, heavily burdened by weapons and bags; in the lands of Akania he was known as Kipox Thief, Master Thief. Nearby a lean figure rested against the rail, looking Westward; he was a Sylvan Elf, well armed but filled with mystery: Corbin he was called. These were the only three left of the adventuring party known as the Renegades; Aquilius had gone West, whilst Ravenoke and Willian had both left without a trace moons before.

For days they travelled northwest along the winding Greyflood, past Freeton until they reached the source of the Starbound River. Six days after their departure from Tharbad, they docked at the spiralling city of Cran Moor, last remnant of ancient Rhudaur. Always they looked fearfully southwest, towards the Scarlet Hills; towards Golsiad.

Late that night, after a strong current and good winds, the tall Tolfalas docked at the small city of Tanger, in Dalmatia.

"We are in safe lands now, my friends! Let us find someone to lead us towards Hamilton!" announced Warren as he set foot on the docks, relaxing beneath the silvery gold flag of the Empire. They found the barracks house, and presented themselves to the officer on duty: "We are envoys of Tharbad to the South, and we bear a message to your King" spoke Sir Warren, holding aloft the Red Arrow.

"My Lords, what you hold should be presented to His Majesty at great haste! Ride forth for Hamilton now, for evil follows close!"

As the warriors galloped through the gates, a crowned figure laughed on a dark thrown...

Three days they rode, pressing their steeds to near exhaustion. The weather was still cold, and spring could not be seen approaching on the night of the 61st. The clouds had gathered, and the road seemed endless. And then their blood ran cold: the clouds, moving in their eternal path, opened to reveal a Black Sun in the skies...

On the road ahead stood three figures cloaked in darkness. The leader held his arm upraised, palm showing.

"Give usss the arrow you bear, and we will let you liiiive." hissed the creature. Even the dauntless courage of Warren wavered as the three stood in fear.

"Bye, Warren!" spat Kipox, vanishing with his ring. At that, Corbin ran shrieking into the night. The horses scattered.

"I will not. Leave us be." faltered the Knight, facing his death determinded.

"Give it to usss. Why wassste your lives for a forgotten causssss?" they spoke, advancing.

Drawing his sword, the Knight conquered his fear and and prepared to die. But as they lunged, Kipox appeared and thrust his sword Longtooth into the heart of one, while Corbin stood up behind them and muttered words of power. With a hiss, Kipox' victim faded into the night, while Warren staggered from a deadly blow. But raising his sword high, he dealt the evil a mortal blow, ripping from it a trailing wail as it too faded away. As the last moved to slay Warren who was caught off balence from the force of his blow, light flooded the area, banishing the last to whence it came.

Just as the party colapsed in exhaustion, they turned to see two Brass Dragons lands in a flurry of wings; from each came a rider in shining plate bearing the Sword and Sun ensigna of Dalmatia, along with the Dragon ensigna of the Royal House.

"Forgive our lateness, Lords; we are glad that you are still alive. News has just reached His Majesty of your errand, and we were sent to ensure your safety as members of the King's High Guard. Please follow to the Dragondome"

And so, as dawn filled the sky, and the sun's first beams shot over the land, the travellers passed through the orchards and tree lined streets of Hamilton, until they approached a great palace of gold and platinum. Tired and dusty, they enterred the thrown room, where a great Throne fashioned in the likeness of a dragon's head stood, seating a kindly king in silver and white atop its outstretched tongue. Though any other man would have colapsed from fatigue, Sir Warren forced himself forward, holding his body upright in all formality. He approached the thrown, and knelt, handing the Red Arrow to King Richard of Dalmatia.

"From Tharbad and what is left of Cardolan, I bring this arrow in their time of need."

And thus the history of all Numedia was changed by the courage and strength of three adventurers from nowhere, remnants of past glory as written by the Master Bard Esgalduin:



Through the great Welkwood Forest to the East,
Over the Tricap Peaks and Karm Tor to the North,
Down the great winding Jackal River like a fleece,
Through Dryer Mob where the Thieves stand forth;

Clearing the lands of both Evil and Beast,
Beneath the silvery gold flag of Sun and Sword.
Under the pinacled rooves of Hamilton's wreath,
From a land far South past remorse,
Through Arina, and Zolna now bequithed,
Over Shem's still steaming vile corpse,
There came the Sons of Fantasy beneath the Moons,
Who became Renegades past Hollin Gate as engraved
in runes.
There was Boromir, tall and proud.
There was Dragonwing, cold of stare,
With Aquilius, whose deeds cried loud,
And Aladin, dead though few care.
There was Woodstock of Garfag's crowd,
And Dremia Sein, Elven fair.
There was Elric, mage of no doubt,
And Warren, master of mare,
With Willian the Vorpalshroud.
There was Kipox, whose hands would dare,
And then Corbin, magik endowed.
And thus it is told from South to far East,
From King to King, father to son, man to beast.



The
-Renegades-
Chapter IX: Happenings

Of the days that followed the confort of the Dragondome, little is said; the Elf trained, gaining skills in ways of battle and general violence, whilst the others rested from their perilous ventures. But idleness was never a favourite among adventurers...

"Slice him, Warren!" shouted Kipox as a great two-handed sword planted its blade in the ground where the Cavalier had been seconds before.

"That's Sir to you, haffer!" shouted the Knight, swinging his great axe at his opponent's neck. Catching only air, the Knight stepped back and the two started to circle. Warren's foe was a great man clad in black plate. Oh, and using a zweihander.

"Ug!" grunted Sir Warren as a great blow hurled him backwards. He straightened himself and then swung high, pulling his axe down in a wide arc; the blade planted itself in the Black Knight's chest, and then fell to the earth along with the other pieces of loose armor. The Black Knight had long been a mystery even before the Renegades had heard of him.

"Pah! Only gold! It's not worth it." muttered Corbin, staring at the pot that lay next to the vacant armor.

"Perhaps you'd rather go back to Karm Tor, Elf? Sure was a lot to do down there!" retorted the Halfling stuffing his pockets.

The three argued, standing in the valley that was called Shem's Pass (named for a Dragon whom Boromir, Willian and Aquilius slew). Near them, as the breeze played with their flying cloaks, stood an Asian man, keeping to himself. he looked darkly at the halfling, and then sighed and looked Eastward. It hadn't been easy keeping up with this group; they had gone from Karm Tor in the East to Dryer Mob, and then to here in four days. But many things had been hurried in the new year of 3112n; Dalmatia had retreated, giving Anor much of South Akania, marching towards Tanger and Cran Moor where a new, unheard of enemy lurked. These were indeed strange times.

For days and many more miles, the party travelled. Through Akan and Caleb in West Akania, and then to Uri in Zhan before the group arrived at the site of Sir Warren's future castle in the Weatherpeaks. There they met the famed Blue Mage, who helped them reach Hrothman's Lair, where Og had been hiding. From there they delved through a small dungeon in the foothills between Akania and its western brother, before they arrived, tired but cheerful, in the Salamander Inn in Lark-Han by the sea on Spring 36th, 3112n.

Just in time to hear a minstrel sing one of the Bard Coleridge's works as the sun set and the ale began to pour;

"In Xanadu did Kubla Khan
A stately pleasure dome decree:
Where Alph, the sacred river, ran
Through caverns measureless to man
  Down to a sunless sea.
So twice five miles of fertile ground
With walls and towers were girdled round:
And there were gardens bright with sinuous rills,
Where blossomed many an incense-bearing tree:
And here were forests ancient as the hills,
Enfolding sunny spots of greenery.

But oh! that deep romantic chasm which slanted
Down the green hill athwart a cedarn cover!
A savage place! a holy and enchanted
As e'er beneath a waning moon was haunted
By woman wailing for her demon lover!
And from this chasm, with ceaseless turmoil seething,
As if this earth in fast thick pants were breathing,
A mighty fountain momently was forced:
Amid whose swift half-intermitted burst
Huge fragments vaulted like rebounding hail,
Or chaffy grain beneath the thresher's flail:
And `mid these dancing rocks at once and ever
it flung up momently the sacred river.
Five miles meandering with a mazy motion
Through wood and dale the sacred river ran,
Then reached the caverns measureless to man,
And sank in tumult to a lifeless ocean:
And `mid this tumult Kubla heard from far
Ancestral voices prophesying war!
     The shadow of the dome of pleasure
     Floated midway on the waves;
     Where was heard the mingled measure
     From the fountain and the caves.
It was a miracle of rare device,
A sunny pleasure dome with caves of ice!

     A damsel with a dulcimer
     In a vision once I saw:
     It was an Abyssinian maid,
     And on her dulcimer she played,
     Singing of Mount Abora.
Could I revive within me
Her symphony and song,
To such a deep delight `twould win me,
That with music loud and long,
I would build that dome in air,
That sunny dome! those caves of ice!
And all who heard should see them there,
And all should cry, Beware! Beware!

His flashing eyes, his floating hair!
Weave a circle round him thrice,
And close your eyes with holy dread,
For he on honeydew hath fed,
And drunk the milk of Paradise."



The
-Renegades-
Wrapsheet

Ordway Street, April `86
Location: Lark-Han (a citystate of importance)
Date : Spring 36th, 3112n (a new year)
Time : Eighth (afternoon)

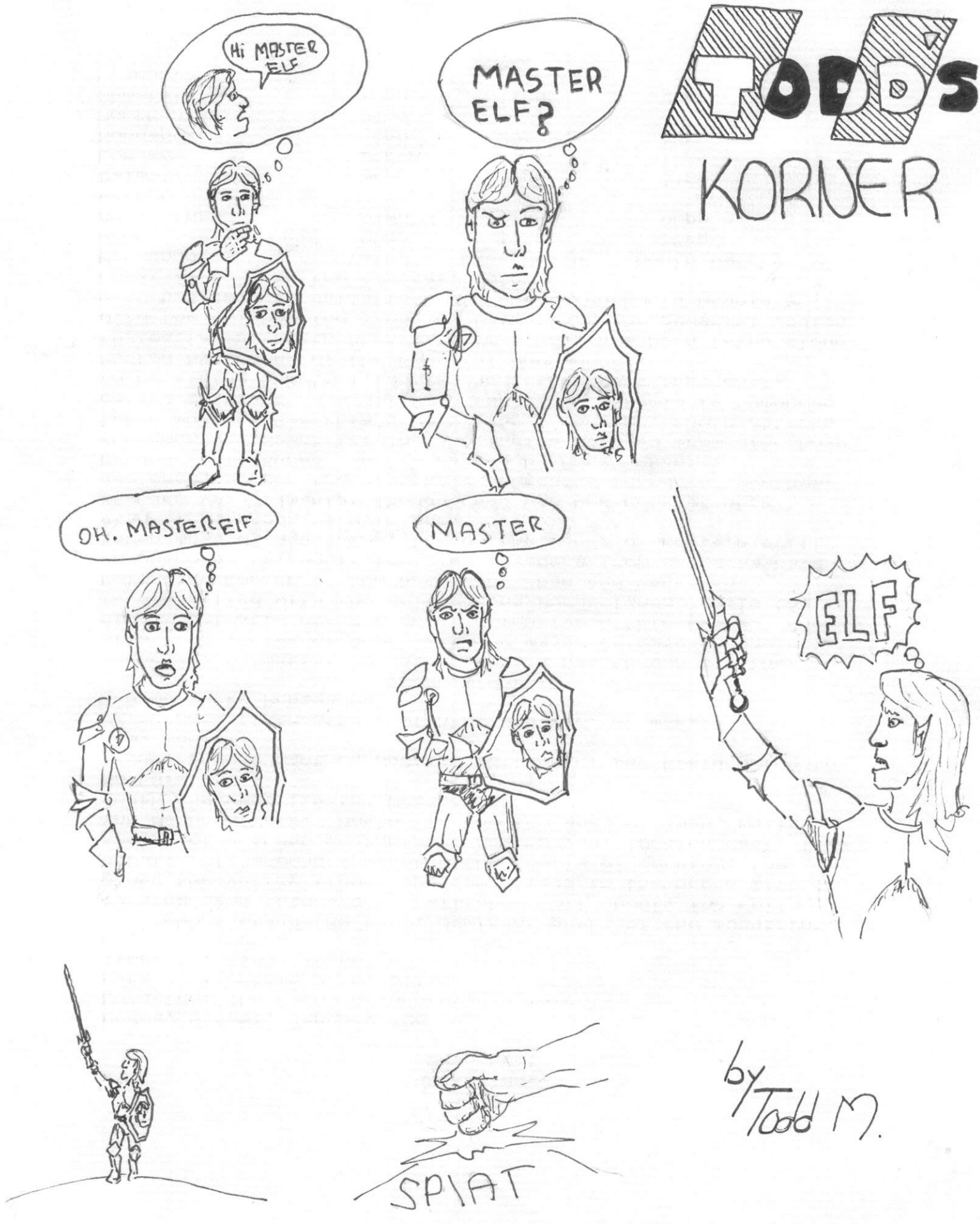
You sit back in your chairs, relaxing as the minstrel plucks the last strings of his song. The air is warm and fresh as you inhale it deeply in your tired lungs. You look about and see Missy darting between the tables, serving the last of the lunch customers. Here in Lark-Han you feel at home, especially in the Salamander Inn where the Sons of Fantasy would stay, once upon a time. But here the Renegades are also known and respected, for woe to he who offends them.

NOTES:
1/All HP's are at their last recorded levels.
2/Please welcome Jim among us for this session.
3/Good luck, Renegades!

TELRHIN UPDATE

*Anor vs. Dalmatia: Dalmatia pulled its great army away towards Cran Moor and ancient Rhudaur, leaving South Akania little defended. Anor took advantage of this and has taken most of South Akania; however, the great fortress of Dar still remains strong and under Dalmatian sway.
*Moonspoken vs. Aquitaine: Falcnor has proclaimed itself master of Aquitaine, and plans to set its capital in the port of Midnight. However, the lands of Poitain have been proclaimed independent, hopefully ceasing the war that was ravaging the area.
*Bardor vs. Vijmania: War is declared, and both sides are ready. Bardor has lost all of its allies, but is still favoured over the nomadic peoples of Vijmania.
*Longmen vs. Semetria: The sea-faring Longmen have taken much of Semetria's coastline. They have declared the lands theirs, under the colony of New Kloss. Kloss has yet to successfully move inland, though it has apparent control over the coast.

War bonds	Value	Last Month	Month Before
Anor	07pp	02pp	05pp
Aquitaine	-	01pp	01pp
Bardor	22pp	20pp	-
Dalmatia	38pp	59pp	50pp
Longmen	24pp	20pp	20pp
Moonspoken	-	36pp	30pp
North Akania	-	01pp	09pp
Semetria	06pp	11pp	10pp
Vijmania	08pp	10pp	-


Hi MASTER ELF
MASTER ELF?
TODD'S KORNER
OH. MASTER ELF
MASTER
ELF
SPIAT
by Todd M.

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[*] stands for cartoons & drawings

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The Review Page

This page is open to everyone. Please hand in your reviews

REALISTIC COMPACT DISC PLAYER 42-5000: Awesome. Price: $150 Quality: 7 Ease of use: 9 Value: 8 Overall: 8

NEW COCA-COLA: (At last!) Very blah. Makes me sick after four or five. Price: $.50 Quality: 3 Ease of use: 10 Value: 7 Overall: 6

TEEN SKI ADVENTURES KILLINGTON TRIP: Not enough dope, and no alcohol. Pisser. Price: $299.95 Quality: 7 Ease of use: ? Value: 7 Overall: 7

DON HUBBARD: Fat. This man is fat. Price: ? Quality: 1 Ease of use: ? Overall: 1

ORIENTAL ADVENTURES BY TSR: Banzai! I love it, except barbarians have got to go! Price: $15 Quality: 9 Ease of use: 7 Value: 9 Overall: 9

THE DISC SHOP AT MAZZA GALLERY: Good selection, and not too much trouble, unless the old guy's there. Price: Ha! Quality: 8 Value: 10 Overall: 9

CALVIN AND HOBBES: This is the best cartoon ever run! I think that all of you who haven't already joined the NicJasonChrisAllLoveC&HClub should do so now! But only if you can tell us how to catch a tiger, and what to do with him once he's caught. Price: n/a Quality:11 Value:10 Ease of Use:10 Overall:10

****
PLEASE HAND IN REVIEWS TO KEEP THIS PAGE FROM EVER AGAIN BEING THIS PATHETIC!!!

JASON'S BOARD

****
Everybody is a wimp and I challenge you all to a fight!
-anon
****
Nef Fate isn't the biggest goof in Greyhawk.
-some god from some pantheon
****
Chris is an incredible goof.
-God
**********RESPONSE**********
No he isn't. I love him
-Orcus
**********RESPONSE**********
Come on! Just look at him!
-Zeus
**********RESPONSE**********
We love him down here!
-Asmodeus
**********RESPONSE**********
Get serious.
-Anon
**********RESPONSE**********
Well, we guess that he is a goof.
-Residents of Hell
****
Watch out, Og, here comes Corbin!
-Anon
****
Chris, I want to go to Moria, but everyone else is scared of it.
-Corbin
**********RESPONSE**********
Maybe it's because they know better.
-Chris
****
Chris, I want to find Arons but no one wants to go with me.
-some whining jap
**********RESPONSE**********
Maybe you should ask around in Belharri.
-Chris
****
"I'm a vulgar man,"
-Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart
****
Chris, I want to die normally, but you won't let me.
-Rankonan
**********RESPONSE**********
Shut up, nerd!
-Chris
****

Sir Borin is a goof and a nerd.
-A "friend" of Kipox

**********RESPONSE**********

Sir Warren?
-anon

**********RESPONSE**********

Shut up, Og!
-Everyone

****

Watch out Orient, here come the Renegades!
-Anon

****

Death to the Serpent Syndicate!
-Kipox

****

Warren and Corbin are idiots!
-anon

****

All gods suck
-Kipox

**********RESPONSE**********

I am going to seperate your atoms and place each one on a seperate plane of the Abyss.
-Some god

****

I would like to extend our sincere felicitations to Jim Reimy for his trial run in our campaign.
-anon

****

Let's go to Ogville.
-anon

**********RESPONSE**********

I just came from there. Its not worth it.
-Tiamat and a few evil hordes.

****

John and Nic are the biggest nerds in every plane in existence.
-Todd, Jason, Chris & Jones

****

Anybody want to buy some drugs?
-anon

**********RESPONSE**********

Sure...oops.
-Sir Borin

**********RESPONSE**********

Shut up, you little runt!
-Anon, anon and anon.

****

The body parts of a dragon are worth much more than the friendship of one.
-Corbin

**********RESPONSE**********

You are a fool, sorcerer.
-Lord Boromir son of Denethor, King of

Borovia, Member of the House of Nairim, Subject of Minas Tirith and Dragonfriend, who sits beside Odin in Valhalla. May his name be remembered.

****

Hey, what happened? Did Og get bored of AD&D too?

-Warren

**********RESPONSE**********

Idiot.

-Og

****

We are not blabbermouthes! What do you ever do with Talon's Claw anyway?

-Corbin

****

Short people ain't got no reason to live.

-anon

**********RESPONSE**********

I agree. If you don't, than please send me your name and where you can be reached while you sleep.

-Rivok

****

I wish people would stop signing letters anonymously!

-anon

****

This is our last game guys!

-anon and anon

Fables of Telrhin
-Kinstl on Kandrag-

by Aldridge

It was dark in the Brass Orchid that night, but then again it always was. The ceiling was thick with smoke, and the tables with beer. Delow was sitting with a patron at his private booth, and Kali was eating Ugly Bud's meat before he could get it onto the stove.

That damned cat, thought the man as he walked past the grill. He looked around, then headed for a booth on the far wall. He was about to sit, when he looked over to the seat next to him. It was empty, and so was the table. he stood up, and stared at the seat.

That's where Kinstl always sits when he's in town, muttered the man. He looked around, and then took a seat. He hadn't heard from the thief in a while, and that worried him. But it shouldn't, he thought, after all, no one ever hears from a thief, its their way.

He sat awhile, thinking of him, until Lily walked over, tray in hand:

"So, whatta you want tonight, Hergon?"

He turned to her, and smiled: "You remember Kinstl, don't you?" he asked.

"Course I remember him! Who could forget 'im? The kid nearly got mauled twice a night, what with all his stealin'!"

"Yeah. Well, bring me a Yahner; you know, what he drinks."

"Sure thing, Hergon, but don't tell me things are all that bad tonight!" she rushed off, and Hergon sat back, thinking. He had always liked the kid, had always admired his nerve.

"I remember when we'd sit at this booth and talk about things. Kinstl'd always be yappin' off about that guy Kandrag. Yeah, he really worshipped that guy. Well, if half of the stories are true, I don't blame him." thought the man, grabbing the two-handled mug that was the symbol of a Yahner. He flipped Lily a silver, and she sat down across from him.

"I was just remembering all the tales Kin used to tell. Especially the one about Kandrag and Port Seldom." he said, dreaming.

"I never heard that one! Tell me, the way Kinstl tells 'em. Please?" she pleaded.

"Like old times, eh Lily? Sure." he answered.

"You see, Kandrag's from Semetria, and he was off after some buried treasure he had found on a scroll. Well, he followed the map, until he came to Seldom. But the thing was, the city'd been built since the treasure was buried, so Kandrag was pretty pissed. He blamed the city for being

there, and had a mind to get revenge. But Kandrag's not a mean guy, so he walked around, pouting until he thinks up this great plan.

"The night comes, and he gets started. He mutters a few prayers to Roan, and then runs around town stealing everyone's laundry from their homes. The whole time, the fog's rolling in from the ocean, so no one notices. Anyway, morning comes, and everbody's shouting wondering what in the nine hells happened to their clothes. Then, the town guards, patrolling the king's garden, stop dead in their tracks: In the king's royal rose garden were a hundred pigs and swine, dressed in the townsmen's best suits and ladies best dresses, tearing up a the king's roses."

"So where's Kandrag while all this's goin' on?" the girl asked.

"Well, Kin would say he's up in the princess's tower laughing his head off, but I'd say he's a good twenty miles away, like any sane person would be."

"Aw, you can't tell 'em the way Kin could. But thanks, 'Gon." he watched as she scurried off, and wondered how she got away with working in a pub, being barely sixteen, and no Numester either!

He looked into his glass, and cursed himself for getting a damn Yahner. He took a sip, grimaced, and swallowed. He looked up, sipping some more. As the disorienting effects of the drink worked their way through his mind, he couldn't help wondering what had kept Kinstl away so long.

"If he's dead," he muttered "I hope he died rich."



ALIGNMENT THEORY

Defining Those Notorious Double Adjectives

by Robert B. DesJardins

Whenever anyone asks me what my favourite aspect of role-playing games is, my answer is quick and definite: character. Playing crabby halflings and insane princes is my bag of tricks. Building a character that I can relate to (not talk to, mind you; I'm not that far gone) is not just fun; it's delightful! Furthermore, it's what the game is all about.

Fortunately, the onus of creating realistic characters for a role-playing game is not entirely on me. The people at TSR, Inc. (geniuses of their own time) have devised a simple system for determining a character's basic personality type. Nine general types (called alignments[1]) are given in the rules of the AD&D® Game. When I am creating my character, I can select an alignment from those given, or use the dice to choose one randomly. Once the character's basic viewpoint is established, everything is set up for me. All I have to do is fill in the details.

Understanding Alignments

Alignment is not just another aspect of role-playing. In my opinion, it is the most important aspect — as crucial to the character as hit points and as necessary for good play as game mechanics.

Unfortunately, some players have trouble grasping the basic concepts behind the various alignments. In some cases, this can be traced to the fact that those players started with the D&D® game, in which the alignment system is not as sophisticated. (In fact, some try to play both at once, and become completely confused.) The D&D game offers only three choices (lawful[2], neutral[2], and chaotic[2]), instead of the tumultous mix-up of nine found in the AD&D game. A player of the D&D game knows that the good guys are usually lawful and the bad guys are usually chaotic. But the AD&D game offers apparently contradictory choices, mixing good and evil with lawful and chaotic, with neutral thrown in for added confusion.

Many of us have seen the problem when a new player enters an AD&D game campaign.

D&D game player: What's chaotic good[1]? Isn't that a paradox?

AD&D game player: No, chaos simply refers to a great respect for individual initiative in achieving one's goals, be they those of good or those of evil. Chaotic good creatures are apt to regard law and order as too restrictive of individual freedom to seek one's own destiny, while chaotic evil[1] creatures may see the weak as cumbersome to society, and the genius of the strong as insurance of a deserving individual's survival.

D&D game player: Oh. I . . . er . . . see.

Ultimately, therefore, a lot of misunderstanding is completely understandable. Take, for example, the lawful neutral[1] alignment. Would the LN creature be friendlier with the lawful good creature or the true neutral creature? What's the difference between these two? Is the LN creature likely to help an evil creature overcome the good guys in battle to help keep balance in the cosmos?

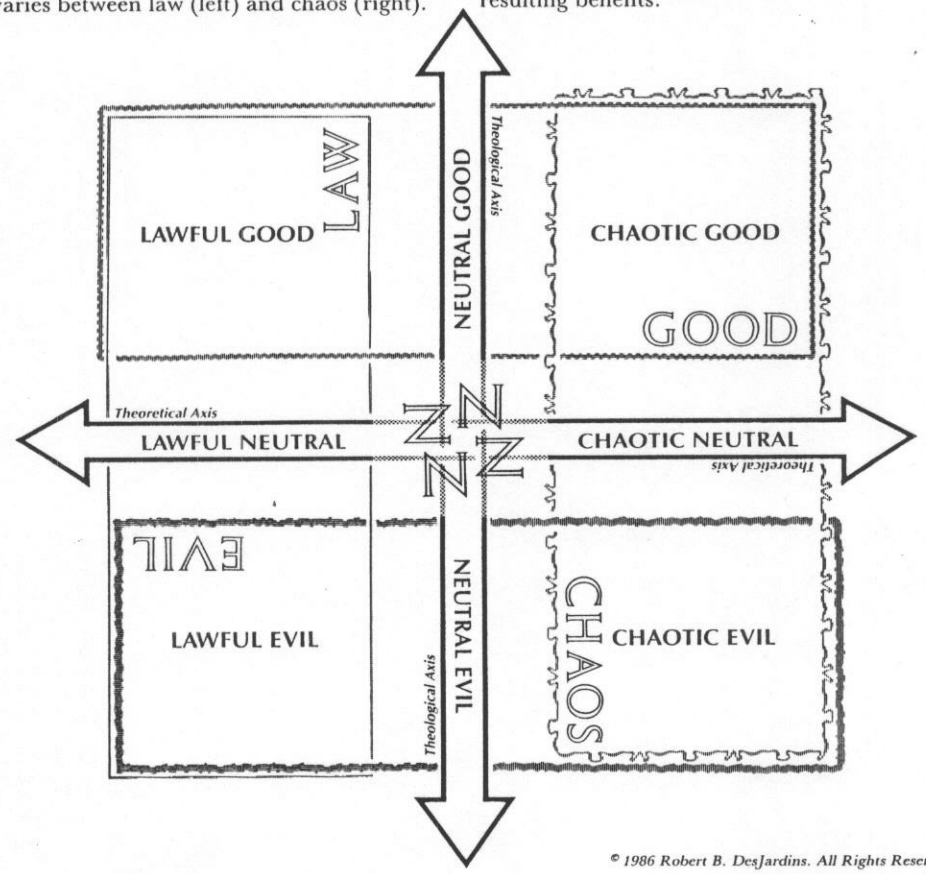
A Pseudo-Mathematical Theory

To answer all these questions, I have taken Mr. Gygax's diagram from the *Players Handbook*, which illustrates the relationship between alignments perfectly, and added a few details on it to produce the diagram illustrated on this page. It displays quite well my understanding (fact or fallacy) of the various alignments and how the concept of neutrality fits in.

First of all, I have superimposed a pair of axes upon the diagram. The horizontal one varies between law (left) and chaos (right). Since it represents basically political opinions, I have named it the *theoretical axis*. Likewise, the vertical axis represents choices of the heart, varying between good (top) and evil (bottom), so I have designated this as the *theological axis*.

We can now, using primitive set theory (I hated it too, but it can occasionally come in handy. Occasionally . . . .) label the set of all points to the left of the vertical axis as *law*, and the set of all points to the right of the vertical axis as *chaos*. Likewise, let's call the set of all points above the horizontal axis *good*, and the set of all points below the horizontal axis *evil*.

Law represents those creatures who believe that organization is the proper way to achieve results, and *chaos* represents those who believe that individual freedom is the best way to achieve one's "proper destiny." Similarly, *evil* represents creatures who believe that the weak and incompetent should have no place on the earth, and that the strong and mighty are the ones who should reap the benefits of her resources, whereas *good* represents those who believe that all creatures should care for one another, and that all should share in the resulting benefits.



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From here, the relationship of our diagram to the original becomes obvious. The area where the sets *law* and *good* intersect (overlap) can be labelled *lawful good*[1]. Characters whose viewpoints fall within this portion of the chart have both lawful and good tendencies, though the exact proportions of each can obviously vary widely. Likewise, the other three intersections of the four basic sets can be labelled *lawful evil*[1], *chaotic good*, and *chaotic evil*.

But although those four extremes take up most of the diagram, they don't represent quite all of the possible points — those on the axes themselves are still unaccounted for. So how should those be characterized in our model? Well, the set of points on the *theoretical axis* is not part of *good* or *evil*; it is something in between. Theologically, all those points are neutral, though they still vary theoretically (along the horizontal axis). Conversely, points on the *theological axis* are theoretically neutral — neither lawful nor chaotic, but something in between.

The intersection of *theological neutrality* (the horizontal axis) and *law* is labelled *lawful neutral*, and the intersection of *theological neutrality* and *chaos* is labelled *chaotic neutral*[1]. Note that *lawful neutral* and *chaotic neutral* are subsets of *law* and of *chaos*, respectively, but not of *good* nor of *evil*. Therefore, both lawful neutral and chaotic neutral creatures are concerned only with theoretical considerations; one is dedicated to pure law and the other to pure chaos. Likewise, *neutral good*[1] and *neutral evil*[1] are subsets of *good* and of *evil*, respectively. Creatures of those alignments are concerned solely with theological concepts, not with which political means are used to achieve them.

The point where the two axes cross is both theologically and theoretically neutral. It is not included in *law, chaos, good*, or *evil*, so we will label it *true neutral*[1].

Interpreting the Chart

At this point, let's try to define what is wrong with the average new player's interpretation of alignment, which basically states that lawful good characters are the nicest and chaotic evil ones are the meanest. This is entirely false, as would be the statement: "The average communist is more "good" than the average capitalist." Law is a theoretical concept, and it is no more "good" than chaos. Neither have any relation to good or evil. Law could only be directly related to good if there were no chaotic good alignment available, not to mention lawful evil. The simple fact that these possibilities exist disproves this theory, at least for game purposes.

Why is this misinterpretation so widespread? Just why is lawful good considered more good than chaotic good, when in fact it is only more organized? Personally, I believe the presence of the various neutral alignments creates the confusion. If the only alignment choices available were lawful good, chaotic good, lawful evil, and chaotic evil, we could readily see that there are two variations of good and two variations of evil. Mentally, such a grouping makes the relationship obvious. A chaotic good creature is free-wheeling and individualistic, while a lawful good creature is orderly, but both have equally good intentions. The "degrees of good" argument does not appear until we add the neutral good alignment. At first glance, neutral good seems to be a sort of half-way point between the other two; hence it appears that the three alignments represent three different "degrees" of goodness. But this couldn't be more wrong.

Neutrality is much simpler than that. Think of the letter "N" as a "neutralizer," crossing off a space where a C, L, G, or E would otherwise appear in a character's alignment designation. On the graph, note that the term "Neutral" applies to points which lie in no more than one of the four main sets. For example, a lawful neutral creature believes that good and evil, as long as they balance each other out, are not really worth considering. Such a creature's decisions are not based on whether the resulting actions are "good" or not, but simply on whether they're orderly, logical and likely to keep things running smoothly.

Similarly, a neutral good creature is not the second nicest type, but a creature devoted totally to good, whose decisions are not based on the degree of freedom or order involved, but rather on the ultimate benefit which can be achieved.

In Practice

All this theory is fine and good, but how do characters with various alignments behave? Consider first a hypothetical situation in which government officials of various good alignments are debating the best way to feed their people.

Lawful Good: Listen, the best way to feed our starving people is by organizing a committee to divide up the responsibility and delegate the jobs to those who are best qualified to handle them. It won't work unless we all know our places in society and act as a well-oiled, national machine.

Chaotic Good: Baloney! If we force people into a totalitarian sort of society, they'll be suffering anyway! Let all men be free to feed themselves without government interference and things will work out a lot better.

Neutral Good: Look, we all agree that our country must have as little suffering as possible. What difference does it make how we do it, as long as we do it? Forget all of these little political ideals; let's feed the people!

All three officials had equally noble intentions; they simply disagreed on the best means of achieving the goal. Now let's look at the interactions of six alignments in a hypothetical role-playing scenario in which a group of good characters meets a group of evil NPCs who oppose their king. Startled, both groups must decide what to do.

Lawful Good: We've discussed this already. We decided that, if the evil group attacks first, we should engage. Otherwise, we let them go their way. After all, it would be pretty tasteless for a group representing an enlightened and progressive country to act so barbarically!

Chaotic Good: Are you blind? Those guys are probably the scouts for the army that's coming to lay siege. Let's get them before they infiltrate!

Neutral Good: Yeah!

LG: But we agreed!

NG: Listen, we know that these people will attack our fair city if we let them pass! He's right — we shouldn't let them get through!

LG: Well, I refuse. There's been no fair trial.

CG: Fine. Then we'll attack, and the two of us will take whatever treasure they have for ourselves. Since you didn't help, you won't get any. How does that grab ya?

LG: What? That's ridiculous! What if there's something only I can use?

CG: Maybe we'll just sell it and keep the money.

NG: Hold on a minute. It would be idiotic not to let him use something that would help all of us simply because he didn't win it in battle. That would be cutting our own throats!

Meanwhile, the evil NPCs, are engaged in a similar debate. Their captain has told them not to attack any armed groups they meet on the road because they must reach their destination.

Lawful Evil: Let's just leave 'em be. As the captain said, it would be taking a risk, and we really do want to make it to the city. We would be more valuable there.

Chaotic Evil: Aw, what does that jerk know? I like the looks of that shiny blade the big lout is carrying. They shouldn't be any problem to take out; besides, the captain would never find out.

Neutral Evil: Well, whaddaya think? They look pretty rich; d'you think we can take 'em?

CE: Sure!

LE: No! If we start disobeying the Cap, we'll never get a crack at that wimp they call king.

CE: But what's this got to do with that? This could just be a profitable side venture.

NE: Yeah, and what if we get smoked?

Note that, in both situations, the theoretically neutral character played the role of mediator, weeding out the most logical and effective way of achieving good or evil, neither consistently lawful nor consistently chaotic.

Rules and regulations aside, the privilege of developing your character's personality is yours. As long as the judge and players mutually agree regarding general alignment principles, there is a wide range of possibilities for individual characters. Choose a general type, and tailor it to suit yourself. Even if you're way out in left field, so to speak, no one from TSR, Inc. is ever going to come and check up on you. The name of the game is enjoyment (speaking figuratively, of course) and that's where the domain of regulations ends. Good gaming and Hasta Manana!

1. From ADVANCED DUNGEONS & DRAGONS® *Players Handbook*, © 1978 TSR, Inc. All Rights Reserved.
2. From the DUNGEONS & DRAGONS® Game, © 1974 TSR, Inc. All Rights Reserved.

AN AD&D® GAME FEATURE

DOMINION

An Unofficial New Spell Category for Magic-Users

by Jon Pickens

In this issue, we continue the "Unofficial New Spells" series with an entirely new magic-user spell category: dominion spells. Previous installments of the series may be found in issues #22, #24, #25, and #26.

I have long felt that the best way to develop a specialized mage is via spell selection within the standard class. Most spell categories (i.e., evocations, alterations, etc.) have enough spells to make this workable. However, there is one spell that doesn't fit into any group: *magic jar.* The development of a spell category into which this spell will fit forms the basis of this installment. The new category, which I call dominion, has its roots in the psionic system, especially the domination discipline. The basic tricks of the mage who specializes in dominion spells include controlling the victim's voluntary muscles and sensory linkages, and finally shifting entire life forces. For campaign play, these spells should be limited to neutral magic-users or evil NPCs, as the classic practitioner is a Sauron-type, sitting in the middle of his zombie army and secretly pulling strings from afar. The seeking and use of these spells are highly questionable activities for good characters.

Empathic Seizure (Dominion)

Level: *1*
Range: *3″*
Duration: *Special*
Area of Effect: *One creature*
Components: *V,S*
Casting Time: *1 segment*
Saving Throw: *Neg.*

Explanation/Description: This spell enables the caster to seize the mind of a single creature and hold its body rigid. To establish the effect, the caster must meet the victim's gaze (automatic unless the victim takes precautions). The spell automatically fails against creatures with more than 6 hit dice (or levels), mindless or unseeing creatures, or opponents warded by *protection from evil.* If the victim takes damage while the spell is in effect, the caster also takes damage equal to 1/4 of the amount inflicted on the victim due to empathic shock. The spell ends when the caster ceases concentration upon it, takes any damage, or is otherwise disturbed.

Empathy (Divination) Reversible

Level: *1*
Range: *1″/level*
Duration: *1 turn*
Area of Effect: *One creature per round*
Components: *V,S*
Casting Time: *1 segment*
Saving Throw: *None*

Explanation/Description: This spell allows the caster to sense the basic needs, drives, and emotions (i.e., hunger, thirst, fear, fatigue, pain, uncertainty, rage, hatred, curiosity, hostility, friendliness, love, etc.) of one or more unshielded sentient minds within range. The caster may probe one creature or object per round. The spell gives no result for creatures protected against such detection (including psionic creatures) or emotionless creatures (such as slimes, oozes, jellies, golems, skeletons, zombies, etc.). Unlike the clerical version, *empathy* allows the caster to detect the presence of psionic ability in a creature or object, and its relative strength (weak, moderate, or strong). The reverse of the spell masks the emotions of any one creature for one turn.

Empathic Control (Dominion)

Level: *2*
Range: *6″*
Duration: *Special*
Area of Effect: *One creature*
Components: *V,S*
Casting Time: *2 segments*
Saving Throw: *Neg.*

Explanation/Description: This spell enables the caster to seize the mind and control the body of a single creature within the spell range. Creatures of more than 6 hit dice (or levels), mindless creatures, and those warded by *protection from evil* are immune to this spell. Although controlled, the victim remains aware and cannot be forced to act against its nature or perform obviously self-destructive acts. If such an order is given, the victim may make a new saving throw vs. death with a +4 bonus; success ends the spell immediately. If the controlled creature takes damage while the spell is in effect, the caster also takes damage equal to 1/4 of that inflicted upon the victim due to empathic shock. The spell ends when the caster loses sight of the creature for any reason, ceases concentration, or takes damage other than empathic shock. (In the latter case, the caster must make a saving throw vs. spells at +2 to maintain control.) It is possible for the caster to send the subject beyond the initial casting range, as long as it remains in sight.

Empathic Link (Dominion)

Level: *3*
Range: *1″/level*
Duration: *Special*
Area of Effect: *One creature*
Components: *V,S*
Casting Time: *3 segments*
Saving Throw: *Special*

Explanation/Description: This spell allows the caster to make empathic contact (cf. *empathy*) with a creature and use its sensory abilities by concentrating on them. In addition, the caster may, once each round the spell is in effect, attempt to influence the victim's actions by concentrating upon that to the exclusion of other activities. Creatures of low or animal intelligence save vs. spells at a penalty of -2 when the spell is cast. Failure means that the spell takes effect, but the victim is entitled to a new saving throw vs. spells each time the caster attempts to influence the victim's actions. A successful saving throw against an attempt to influence means that the specific attempt has failed but the spell itself remains in effect. Unwilling recipients of exceptional intelligence (15 or better) save vs. spells with a +2 bonus for each attempt to influence, and are free of the spell if successful. The victim cannot in any case be forced to act against its nature or to perform obviously self-destructive acts; any such orders are simply ignored. Mindless creatures and those warded by *protection from evil* are immune to this spell.

Once the *link* is established, the distance to which the creature can be sent is limited only by its movement within the spell's duration. If the creature takes damage while the *link* is in use, the caster also takes damage equal to 1/4 of that inflicted upon the victim, up to the creature's total number of hit points, due to empathic shock. While using a subject's senses, the caster is vulnerable to any sensory attack (i.e. gaze, sonic, olfactory, etc.) to which the victim is subjected. The caster may break the link voluntarily, which ends the spell; otherwise, the duration is 5 rounds/level.

Domination (Dominion)

Level: *4*
Range: *1″/level*
Duration: *Special*
Area of Effect: *One creature*
Components: *V,S*
Casting Time: *4 segments*
Saving Throw: *Neg.*

Explanation/Description: This spell allows the caster to control the actions of any one creature (including undead) until the caster ceases concentration, takes damage, or is otherwise disturbed, though the caster may move at up to half normal speed without relinquishing control. When the spell is cast, the victim must make a saving throw vs. spells at a penalty of -2. Failure indicates that the spell has taken effect. Victims ordered to take actions against their nature receive a new saving throw at a bonus of +1 to +4, depending upon the severity of the action required. Obviously self-destructive orders are ignored, but the spell remains in effect. Once

control is established, there is no limit to the range at which it can be exercised as long as the victim is on the same plane as the caster. The caster does not receive direct sensory input, but does have a telepathic link with the recipient. Unlike lower level spells of this type, the caster takes no empathic damage if the recipient is damaged. A successful saving throw means that the creature is *slowed* for 1d4 rounds, but *protection from evil* blocks this spell completely.

Major Domination (Dominion)

Level: *6*
Range: *1″/level*
Duration: *2 rounds/level*
Area of Effect: *One creature*
Components: *V,S*
Casting Time: *6 segments*
Saving Throw: *Special*

Explanation/Description: This is generally the same as the fourth-level *domination* spell, except that failure to gain or maintain control over the victim does not end the spell. The caster may attempt to establish control once per round until the spell duration expires, but may not attempt to take over a specific creature more than once per game turn, and only one subject may be controlled at a time. The *slowing* effect lasts 1d4 rounds after the caster ceases concentration on the victim. *Protection from evil* blocks the effects of this spell.

Enhanced Empathy (Dominion)

Level: *7*
Range: *1″/level*
Duration: *5 rounds/level*
Area of Effect: *Caster only*
Components: *V,S*
Casting Time: *7 segments*
Saving Throw: *Special*

Explanation/Description: This spell improves the effect of empathic spells of third level or less. While this spell is in effect, saving throws against any of the caster's empathic spells are made at a penalty of -4. In addition, the caster is completely protected against empathic shock damage.

Mahlorn's Mental Transfer (Dominion) Reversible

Level: *8*
Range: *1″*
Duration: *Special*
Area of Effect: *One creature*
Components: *V,S,M*
Casting Time: *8 turns*
Saving Throw: *None*

Explanation/Description: By means of this spell, the caster can place a creature's life force (even his own) into a specially fabricated item or magical construct. The creature's body falls into a state of catalepsy when its life force enters the item, and remains so until the life force returns. While in the construct, the creature may perform any action permitted by the new form. In an item such as a ring or a sword, the creature may communicate telepathically with the user when the item is held or worn properly. In the case of special statues, a spellcaster might even employ his own spells (DM discretion).

If the creature's body is destroyed while its life force is in the construct, it is trapped in the item. If the item is destroyed while the creature's life force is in it, the creature may regain its body by making a system shock roll if the body is within 1 mile per caster level of the construct when it is destroyed; otherwise the creature's life force is snuffed out. The *mental transfer* cannot be *dispelled* normally, though the creature's life force may be driven out of the construct with an *exorcism* spell.

The material components of the spell are a construct to house the life force, a scroll inscribed with special rare inks, and a 5000 gp gem, which is consumed in the process. The exact nature of the construct allowed is decided upon by the DM, but it must be magical and its cost should not be less than 150% of the gold piece sale cost of a magical version of the item. (For example, a *sword +1* enchanted for this purpose should cost at least 3,000 gp.)

The original scroll, the construct, and the body of the recipient are required to reverse the spell. Both the scroll and the construct are destroyed in this process.

Malhorn's Mental Exchange (Dominion)

Level: *9*
Range: *6″*
Duration: *Special*
Area of Effect: *Special*
Components: *V,S*
Casting Time: *9 segments*
Saving Throw: *Special*

Explanation/Description: This spell allows the caster to mutually transfer life forces between two creatures. The recipients must be



within 20′ of each other at the time the spell is completed, or it automatically fails. When the spell is used correctly, both creatures are surrounded by sparkling green flashes and must save vs. spells at -6 to avoid the effects. If both fail, then the spell takes effect. If one creature saves and the other fails, the one who saves is automatically stunned (reeling and unable to take actions) for 1 round, and the other is automatically stunned for 1-4 rounds.

In a successful transfer, both life forces retain all mental abilities and behavior patterns, though their physical abilities are limited by their new forms. Creatures unaccustomed to being shifted this way are stunned for a minimum of 1 round after the transfer.

If one of the bodies is slain, the spell ends immediately. The life force of the slain body departs (as per normal death), and the other life force snaps back to its body. The surviving entity must immediately make a system shock check or die. (For creatures, use 80% + 1% per hit die instead of the system shock check.) In rare cases (2%), the life force of a creature whose body has been slain does not depart, but coexists in the host body with the original owner. Such a life force may be able to take control of the survivor — use the control rules for the *magic jar* spell to determine this. Note that the "guest" life force cannot be ejected, only suppressed, unless *exorcised*. Otherwise, the spell effect lasts 1 turn per caster level. At the end of this time, the life forces are automatically returned to their respective bodies as soon as the bodies are within 20′ of each other.

Mass Domination (Dominion)

Level: *9*
Range: *6″*
Duration: *Special*
Area of Effect: *3″ cube*
Components: *V,S*
Casting Time: *9 segments*
Saving Throw: *Special*

Explanation/Description: This is a more powerful form of the fourth-level *domination* spell. The *mass domination* spell affects up to two levels or hit dice per level of the caster and the initial saving throw against the effect is made at a -4 penalty. The *dominated* creatures must generally obey the caster, though obviously self-destructive orders are ignored. In addition, the caster can, at will, automatically establish either an *empathic link* (as the third-level spell) or a direct *domination* (as the fourth-level spell) on an individual under *mass domination*, simply by concentrating on it. At no time does the caster take empathic damage for creatures under *mass domination*.

Except when concentrating on an individual, the caster has full normal capabilities. *Dominated* creatures are entitled to normal saving throws against the effects of mass domination in the same way and at the same times as the *charm* spell (cf. the second level druid spell). There is no limit to range of this spell's effects, but the caster cannot establish a link with or directly dominate a creature not currently on the same plane.

For every four hit dice per level (or fraction thereof) controlled simultaneously, the caster's constitution is temporarily lowered one point. For example, the constitution of an 18th-level caster *mass dominating* 75 HD of creatures is temporarily 2 points lower than normal. The spell ends when the caster is utterly destroyed or voluntarily ceases control.

Cantrips for clerics

0-level magic for deities to dish out

by Arthur Collins

By now, everyone ought to be familiar with cantrips, the 0-level spells cast by apprentice magic-users and illusionists. This article details a similar sort of 0-level spell particularly for clerics and druids, called the orison.

These 0-level clerics and druids are sometimes called postulants, thurifers, servers, or inquirers. They are also called *gofers* by some, as their place in the religious hierarchy is such that they are always being told to "go fer this" and "go fer that." (The druidical cult spells it *gopher*, but that is an inside joke.) At any rate, they are apprentices, so to speak, receiving their basic education before taking their initial vows.

While undergoing their basic religious indoctrination, they learn certain standard prayers and responses, the more powerful of which are called orisons. These are minor spells of limited effect. After the postulants go on to enter their callings, these orisons are usually left behind for more powerful spells. However, any cleric or druid may choose to memorize and employ two orisons in place of a 1st-level spell. Each 0-level cleric or druid learns 7-10 of these minor spells during one's time of basic instruction.

In parties that are chronically short of clerical or druidical help, the DM may opt to allow characters of other classes (rangers or paladins) to use these orisons. A PC with a religious education might remember 2-3 of these orisons from one's training. One would still have to pray every morning for them, just as a cleric or druid would, however. This should be done *only* with the DM's permission. Orisons should be assigned randomly to such characters, while a cleric or druid can (in fact, must) pray for specific ones.

Most orisons work for either clerics or druids, though a few are class-specific. Below is a listing of orisons by class, with explanations and descriptions to follow.

	Clerical orisons	Druidical orisons
1	*Aspiration*	*Aspiration*
2	*Benediction*	*Benediction*
3	*Candle*	*Canticle*
4	*Canticle*	*Cure Minor Wnds.*
5	*Ceremony: Oath*	*Find a Stray*
6	*Cure Minor Wnds.*	*Malediction*
7	*Malediction*	*Meditation*
8	*Meditation*	*Petition*
9	*Petition*	*Ripen*
10	*Warding*	*Warding*

Note: In the information below, certain abbreviations have been used. R = range, D = duration, AE = area of effect, C = components, CT = casting time, and ST = saving throw.

Aspiration (Invocation)
R: 0
D: 6 turns
AE: Caster
C: V,S
CT: 1 segment
ST: None

An *aspiration* is a quick prayer on the order of, "Give me strength!" or "Don't let me goof up!" In game terms, it permits a nervous player to pre-roll a dice roll. The player-caster rolls a d20 out of the player's own sight for the DM, who records it. At any time during the next game hour, the caster may appeal to have a bad die roll replaced by the hidden roll. The d20 can be applied as a "to hit" roll, a saving throw, or, by multiplying it by five, a percentile dice roll. Upon the caster's request, whatever was rolled in casting the orison is revealed, and becomes the official dice roll. There is no guarantee that the previous roll will be better, but it will be a second chance. The somatic component is the caster's ritual sign.

Benediction (Conjuration/Summoning)
Reversible
R: 1″
D: 2 melee rounds
AE: 1″ x 1″ square
C: V,S
CT: 2 segments
ST: None

A *benediction* is a minor form of *bless*, raising morale of friendly creatures by +1, and their hit probability by +1. It will not affect those already engaged in combat. It requires no material component.

Candle (Alteration; clerical only)
R: Touch
D: 2 turns
AE: 1 candle
C: V,S,M
CT: 1 segment
ST: None

When casting this orison, the caster causes the candle held in his hand to light. Throughout the orison's duration, the candle cannot be put out as long as the caster continues to hold it. The candle will be consumed normally, but drafts, *gusts of wind*, and so on cannot extinguish the flame. Drowning or smothering the flame will extinguish it, however.

Canticle (Alteration)
R: 0
D: Special
AE: Caster
C: V
CT: Special
ST: None

A *canticle* is a minor form of *sanctuary*, and casting it requires the chanting of portions of the cleric's sacred literature. As long as the chanting continues, opponents must make a saving throw at +2 in order to strike or otherwise attack the caster. The caster cannot engage in any other activity than slow movement (6″ rate) during this time. For other effects, see the description of the *sanctuary* spell.

Ceremony: Oath (Conj./Summoning; clerical only)
R: Touch
D: Special
AE: 1 person of the caster's religion
C: V,S,M
CT: 3 segments
ST: None

A person taking an *oath* in the presence of a cleric pledges his honor to do some minor task. The cleric proffers his holy symbol for both parties involved in the *oath* to touch, and ratifies the *oath* with his ritual sign and some formula such as "so be it." The *oath* stands until the pledge is fulfilled or broken. If broken, the oathtaker (whether the cleric himself or some other person of the cleric's religion) will lose −5% on his loyalty base until satisfactory reparations are made (if ever). Note that a third party of the caster's religion can pledge his honor for the *oath* of a non-believer. In this case, both join in touching the cleric's holy symbol while the orison is cast. The cleric can pledge his own honor for a non-believer, but this is an extremely rare circumstance. The penalty to loyalty base simulates the loss of honor to the oathbreaker.

Cure Minor Wounds (Necromantic)
R: Touch
D: Permanent
AE: Character touched
C: V,S (plus M for druids)
CT: 2 segments
ST: None

A minor *cure*, similar to all other *cure* spells, this orison will heal 1-4 hit points of damage. Note that this spell is not reversible. See the *cure light wounds* description for more information.

Find a Stray (Divination; druidical only)
R: 2 miles
D: Special
AE: 1 domestic animal and the caster
C: V,S,M
CT: 3 segments
ST: None

This orison enables the caster to locate any missing domestic animal within two miles. The animal could be a cow, sheep, dog, horse, cat, or any other such "normal" beast. The caster stands in a place well-known to the animal (a barnyard, pasture, etc.), spits on the ground, makes a sign, and calls the animal by name (Rover, Buttercup, Porky, Old Tom, etc.). If the animal is within two miles of the caster, the caster's tongue will tingle slightly, and give him direction by the manner of its tingling as to where and about how far off the animal is. The effects will last until the animal is found, the caster gives up, or the animal moves beyond a two-mile distance from the caster.

Malediction (Conjuration/Summoning)
R: 1″
D: 2 melee rounds
AE: 1″ × 1″ square
C: V,S
CT: 2 segments
ST: None

The reverse of *benediction, malediction* will lower the morale of opponents by a −1 penalty and lower their "to hit" scores by −1. It does not affect those already engaged in combat. No material components are required.

Meditation (Conjuration/Summoning)
R: Touch
D: 1 turn
AE: Caster
C: V,S
CT: 3 segments
ST: None

A minor (and non-reversible) form of *remove fear,* a *meditation* is an orison of personal encouragement that gives the caster (and only the caster) a +2 on all saving throws vs. the various sorts of magical *fear* attacks for 1 turn.

Petition (Conjuration/Summoning)
R: Special
D: 1 day
AE: Caster's patron
C: V,S
CT: 1 segment
ST: Neg.

Petitions are a staple of all prayers, in all religions. Most favors asked of one's deity are answered in terms of lucky dice rolls and other game mechanics. This orison constitutes a direct appeal of a very limited nature to the caster's deity or other patron. If the deity or patron fails his or her saving throw (2 for gods and demigods, 3 for heroes in the *Legends & Lore* book), the request will be heard, and if it's not too much trouble, some minion or servant of the deity might act upon it. Examples of such minor petitions are to find something minor, meet someone, remember something forgotten, make a favorable impression, and so on. A *petition* is only good for one day. If it is not granted that day, or if no opportunity for its granting comes up, it is wasted, and another *petition* must be made the next day.

Any attempt to abuse this orison with powerful requests ("Oh, please let me find a *ring of three wishes*!") will be met with divine punishment if it is heard. Punishment may consist of a loss of spell-casting power, hit points, or other power or ability, as desired by the DM. However, punishments are rarely severe or last long — unless the caster is guilty of multiple abuses.

Ripen (Alteration; druidical only)
R: Touch
D: Permanent
AE: 1 lb. of fruit
C: V,S,M
CT: 2 segments
ST: None

By casting this orison, the user causes unripe fruit to ripen. The material component is the druid's mistletoe, oak leaves, or holly berries.

Warding (Abjuration)
R: Touch
D: 2 rounds
AE: Creature touched
C: V,S,M
CT: 2 segments
ST: None

This orison is a very minor form of *protection from evil.* For two rounds, it will prevent enchanted, conjured, or summoned creatures from making bodily contact with the recipient, by encircling him or her with magical protection at a distance of one foot. However, it gives no penalty to any attacks that do not involve such contact, and adds no bonuses to one's saving throws. To complete the spell, the caster sprinkles holy water on the recipient. ♈

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